Centre to fly them LMO via Air Force sorties.[29] LMO being highly flammable could not be transported by air, it would explode. The prime minister suggested to his team that if LMO couldn't be transported by air, empty tankers could surely be! On the instruction of the prime minister, the Indian Air Force stepped in to conduct sorties to lift empty tankers and transported them to the plants for refilling, thus cutting down travel time of bringing empty tankers back to the production sites. The final option to reduce total travel time was to transport LMO-filled tankers by rail.

However, the empowered group on logistics and supply (EG2) found that the height of the most tankers being used in India interfered with the height of rail over bridges and overhead equipment at several locations along the railway route. After an analysis of various tanker sizes in use, the Group found that only road tankers T1618, which had the height of 3,320 mm, could be used and that too only if they would be placed on flat wagons (DBKM), with a height of 1,290 mm. In addition, to prevent any hazardous events, route clearances would have to be taken and speed restrictions would have to be imposed along some sections on the routes, depending on overhead clearances. On 18 April, a successful trial was organized at the Boisar Railway Station along the Western Railway line in the Mumbai Metropolitan region where a loaded T1618 tanker was placed on a flat DBKM and all the required measurements were taken. The Oxygen Express took its first route on 19 April, as 10 empty tankers from the Kalamboli Railway Station in Maharashtra were sent to Vishakhapatnam and Jamshedpur for loading of LMO tankers and brought back successfully.[30]

A week later, the prime minister, still noticing a crunch in oxygen availability, in a rather off-beat pilot floated the idea if temporary COVID-19 care centres could be built around industrial units which produce gaseous oxygen of requisite purity, especially those closer to urban and high caseload areas. He was advised that many industries such as steel plants, refineries with petrochemical units, industries using rich combustion processes and power plants have oxygen plants that produce gaseous oxygen, which could be tapped for medical use. Five such COVID-19 care centres were set up as an experiment, which would make about 10,000 oxygenated beds available in a very short period of time.[31] He also noted the progress on 1,500 Pressure Swing Adsorption plants being established through the contribution of the PM CARES fund and other public-sector undertakings (PSUs) and directed the officials to fast-track their set-up as